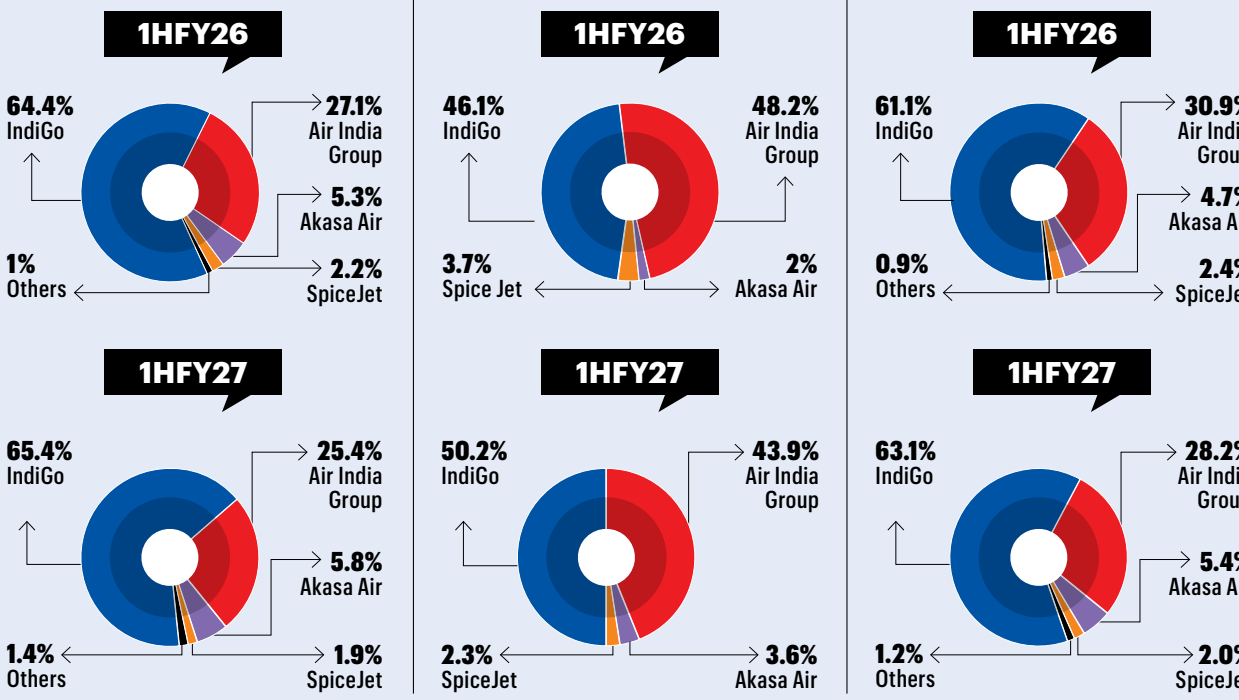
INDIGO RISING

IndiGo continues to dominate the skies, Air India slips, and Akasa emerges as the dark horse

MARKET SHARE



NOTE *INDIAN CARRIERS

SOURCE EQUIRUS SECURITIES

tunately, in Europe and America, has been affected by the airspace closure. Delhi is more affected than Mumbai. We are moving (higher frequency) the US and Europe connectivity to Mumbai from Delhi and also looking at Bengaluru as the third hub for its operations," he said, sharing the immediate strategy to reduce the growing losses.

Gebremariam took over the reins at Air India last month. He also said that he is focused on making the loss-making airline a profitable business, and expressed hope that profitability will come "very soon" through a combination of revenue growth and enhanced efficiencies on the cost side.

Air India has reduced frequency on some of the long-haul flights to the US, Europe, and Australia due to geopolitical issues. Gebramarium said that these routes will be back once conditions improve and the airline is looking to place more orders for wide-body aircraft.

"Air India has been punching below its weight. Right now, our immediate focus is to regain (international) market share from the competition...we will work very hard to regain that market," he said, adding that the large Indian diaspora all over the world alone is a significant market segment for Air India. BT

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